Mesopotamia & Sumer -- Key Words (Answer key)

Name: _____

Word bank: alliance · artisan · city-state · cradle of civilization · cuneiform · epic · Fertile Crescent · hereditary · irrigation · Mesopotamia · monarchy · polytheism · scribe · silt · surplus · ziggurat

Write the word from the word bank that matches each meaning.

1. "the land between the rivers" (Greek); between the Tigris and Euphrates Rivers
   Mesopotamia
2. A city and the lands around it, with its own government, not part of a larger state
   city-state
3. A curving strip of good farmland from the Mediterranean Sea to the Persian Gulf
   Fertile Crescent
4. A government ruled by a king
   monarchy
5. A large temple; the name means "to rise high"; the top was the god's home
   ziggurat
6. A long poem that tells the story of a hero
   epic
7. A name for Mesopotamia: the beginning of organized human society
   cradle of civilization
8. A skilled worker who makes things like cloth, pottery, tools, and weapons
   artisan
9. An agreement to help each other and protect common interests
   alliance
10. An extra amount (of food)
    surplus
11. An official record keeper
    scribe

12. Passed down in a family: when the king died, his son took over
    hereditary

13. Small particles of soil left behind by floods; very good for farming
    silt

14. Sumerian writing made of wedge-shaped marks cut into damp clay with a sharp reed
    cuneiform

15. Watering crops by digging canals that carry water from a water source to the fields
    irrigation

16. Worshipping many gods
    polytheism